



Image by Silvia Draz / Thiiirdmagazine.co.uk

Caption: 'Water No Get Enemy', Defiant Beauty, 2021

## The way media language incorporates viewpoints and ideologies.

On closer inspection, there are several other referential codes that some readers may pick up on more than others. Her head-dress is given extra height and importance by being wrapped around what looks like a book, but is in fact a packet of Africa's Finest Plantain Fufu. Some will recognise a playful stylised, postmodern reference to a common ingredient in some kitchens, that is perhaps a closed cultural reference. The logo on her top is for the Chinese fashion brand UOOYAA. It is not clear whether either of these are sponsored content or just props; but elsewhere in THIIIRD, there is an article about the ideology of the UOOYAA brand:

*'UOOYAA (pronounced as "ow-ya") made its debut in the fashion industry in 2014 as a size-friendly fashion brand that doesn't sit well with what Chinese mainstream media and beauty ideals stand for. The name itself was born out of the willingness to break apart from a white-centric idealisation of beauty, typical of China, that idolises white western women.'*<sup>5</sup>

It is clear that these references chime with THIIIRD'S overarching message of mixed cultural heritages intersecting in a new third space. This young black model is therefore a figure to be admired, respected and looked up to.

You could select your own images and see what meanings resonate with your own

cultural experiences, and investigate if there are any further references signifying alternative layers of meaning.

## Theoretical perspectives

### Theoretical approaches to postmodernism – Jean Baudrillard

THIIIRD can be seen as a postmodern magazine in as much as it is a bricolage of voices, perspectives and multicultural references, all colliding with each other in a bright and colourful, polysemic landscape. Jean Baudrillard argues that in a postmodern age, we are immersed in a world of simulacra where images no longer refer to anything 'real'. However, THIIIRD does the opposite. Rather, it wants to shine a spotlight on the validity of every contributor's real lived experience, and to champion their reality, rarely seen in mainstream media. THIIIRD's production team are presented as trustworthy people we can relate to, because they are just like us. The contributors' stories are authentic, whether they are an Olympic champion or a horse rider at stables in a South London housing estate. Their costume may be stylised as a fantasy element of their reality, but they are presented as admirable people in a very real, down to earth location.

## PART 2 STARTING POINTS: Representation

**The way events, issues, individuals (including self-representation) and social groups (including social identity) are represented through processes of selection and combination.**

THIIIRD's primary subject matter is to discuss issues of representation. Their purpose is to shine a light on and amplify the voices of those individuals, social groups, issues and events rarely seen or heard about in the mainstream media. A glance at the selection of images and lead stories on the home page illustrate the breadth of their reach. There

<sup>5</sup> <https://www.thiiirdmagazine.co.uk/stories/uoooyaa-the-brand-clearing-the-made-in-china-label-of-its-bad-rep>